



SINJIN, THANK YOU

More scholars.
More reach.
More futures.

What your relationships
can make possible next

With gratitude to Claire, Lucas and Bigglesworth September 18, 2026



You helped build a lasting community



90+

CYSTEM alumni

21 / 21

2025-26 scholars at GDC

Four years of support,
relationships and opportunity.

Your idea reached people in 17 states

37

submissions

17

states

15

people recognized

40+

workshop
participants

**“Words can not express how helpful this is
to supporting my college education”**

Emma-Seles Baptiste, IGNITE Impact Challenge award recipient

Your contribution: the idea, the partners and the support. Source: IGNITE executive summary, September 16.

The next opportunity is more people

Scholars

Applications are open

Target 40 graduate scholars, up from 21 last year.

Funding

Model the partners together

Houser \$50K + Take-Two \$25K + Bigglesworth \$50K.

Mentors

Your industry contacts matter

More graduate scholars need people in their corner.

Directory

Reach beyond our own awards

Help graduate students find their next opportunity.

Applications close October 2. Funding amounts above are a working scenario, not a cash balance or approval.

40 graduate scholars. Nearly double the cohort.

2025-26 COHORT

21

graduate scholars

All 21 attended GDC 2026.

NEXT COHORT TARGET

40

graduate scholars

19 more people. About 90% growth.

Target, subject to confirmed funding and delivery capacity. Baseline: Alex Rogers, 2025-26 CYSTEM highlights.

CYSTEM 2026: graduate talent, nationwide

ENTIRELY FOCUSED ON GRADUATE STUDENTS

A wider graduate intake

Students from all
graduate schools can apply.

Nominations help.
They are no longer the gate.

\$1,500 per scholar

A smaller cash award.
A larger graduate cohort.

Previously \$5,000.
Mentors and community continue.

All graduate recipients are CYSTEM Scholars. This funding scenario supports graduate students only.

What a graduate scholar receives

\$1,500

A grant for each selected graduate scholar

Learning

Online curriculum for the path into games

Community

A cohort of peers beyond your own campus

Mentorship

Guidance and connections with industry professionals

Apply directly by October 2. No nomination required.

For the HEVGA follow-up. GDC is a planned capstone; travel and participation support are still being finalized.

More scholars, with people in their corner

40

graduate scholars

An award and a place
in the community.

8

industry mentors

One mentor for every
five graduate scholars.

120

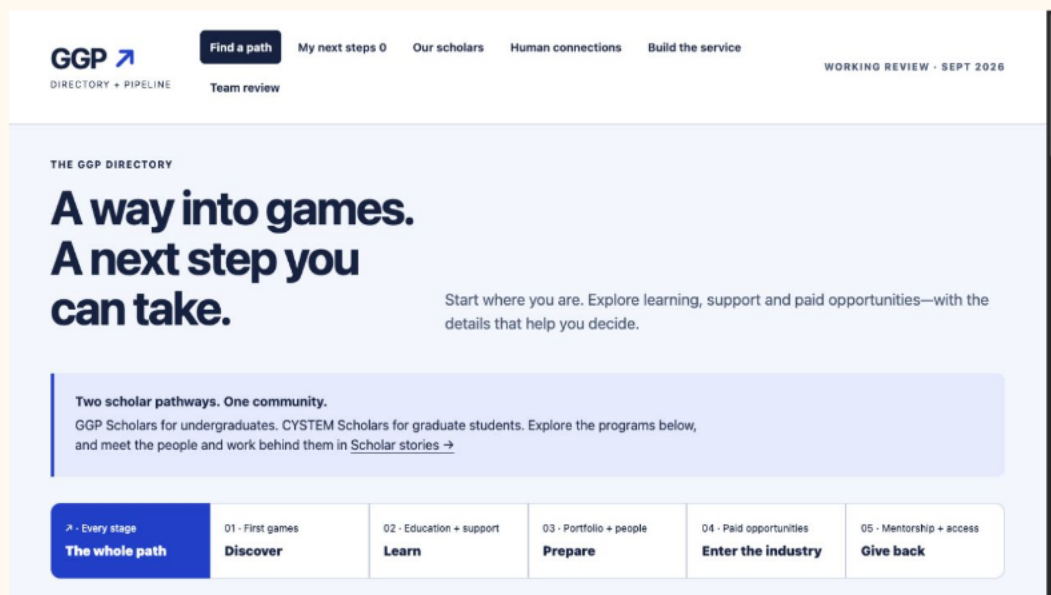
mentor conversations

Three individual
conversations per
scholar.

40 portfolios or career plans reviewed. A clear next step for each scholar.

Proposed graduate-cohort service goals. Mentor commitments and delivery capacity must be confirmed.

The Directory can help more graduate students



**Sinjin: bring foundation partners,
industry mentors and reviewers.**

BUILDING ON YOUR SEPTEMBER PREVIEW

1,000

graduate students use the Directory

100

graduate students take a next step

Pipeline: connect graduate scholars
to people who can help.

Proposed September 2027 goals, not a forecast. Pilot first. Separate budget. Users and scholars overlap; do not add the counts.

More people, with help that lasts

Q4 2026

OCT - DEC

40 scholars

Select and welcome
the expanded cohort

Sinjin

Connect funders
Recruit mentor leads

Bigglesworth

Approve the \$50K ask

**19 more graduates
than last year**

Q1 2027

JAN - MAR

40 introductions

Match each scholar
with an industry mentor

Sinjin

Bring mentors
Bring GDC sponsors

Bigglesworth

Consider Tea support

**Each scholar has
someone to turn to**

Q2 2027

APR - JUN

120 conversations

Three mentor sessions
per scholar by June

Sinjin

Bring practitioners
Connect peer funders

Bigglesworth

Share the evidence

**40 reviewed portfolios
or career plans**

Q3 2027

JUL - SEP

1,000 grad users

Graduate Directory use
Mentor recruitment

Sinjin

Bring distribution
and ERG partners

Bigglesworth

Shape renewal support

**100 people take
a useful next step**

Proposed goals, subject to funding and delivery capacity. Directory reach overlaps the cohort and uses a separate budget.

Q4: forty awards, with the support to succeed

THE KNOWN AWARD COST

40 × \$1,500

\$60,000 in awards

8 industry mentors proposed.
One mentor for five graduates.

THE FUNDING CONVERSATION

\$125K if all partners confirm

Houser \$50K + Take-Two \$25K
+ Bigglesworth proposed \$50K

Agree the costs and permitted
uses
of the remaining \$65K.

Q1: every scholar meets someone who can help

40 COMPLETED MENTOR INTRODUCTIONS

**A person to ask.
A reason to follow up.**

Sinjin: bring industry mentors
and a studio sponsor.

Bigglesworth: help sustain
the Tea Party community.

**Online access includes scholars
who cannot travel to GDC.**



Proposed goal for the 40-scholar model. GDC gatherings March 1-2. Travel and event support need their own confirmed budgets.

Q2: turn introductions into useful help

120

mentor conversations

40

reviewed portfolios
or career plans

The effect: specific feedback and a clearer next move.

Sinjin: bring reviewers, practitioners and Games Challenge backers.

Bigglesworth: bring the evidence to aligned foundations. Goals are proposed; interviews, offers and paid work are tracked separately.

Q3: help more people find their next step

A GOAL FOR SEPTEMBER

1,000 graduate users
100 next steps taken

Sinjin: connect ten partners
who can share the Directory.

Bigglesworth: help bring
aligned foundations into the work.



July KiKi / Cookout target
Recruit industry mentors
for graduate scholars.

Proposed, overlapping reach goals. Directory and event budgets are separate. Annual report counts people and completed actions.

40 scholars. More people with a way forward.

19 more graduate scholars

A target of 40, compared with 21 last year. About 90% growth.

8 industry mentors

Your contacts can give 40 scholars people in their corner.

Reach beyond the cohort

Help 1,000 graduate students find an opportunity.

Proposed goals. Thank you, Sinjin, Claire and Lucas. Your relationships can help more people take the next step.